

MARLENA A. BRANHAM

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EDUCATION

University of Michigan, School of Information

Master of Science in Information, User Research & Design | May 2025

Graduate Certificate in Advanced Studies of Innovation and Entrepreneurship, U-M College of Engineering

University of Michigan, College of Literature, Science, and the Arts

Bachelor of Arts, Biopsychology, Cognition, and Neuroscience | December 2021

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Product & Digital Strategy Consultant | Independent Consulting | Remote | November 2025 - Present

- Translated Spark Beauty Co.'s business goals into a redesigned website centered on its services and booking journey, contributing to a 25% increase in bookings completed through the site.
- Created marketing materials tailored to Thoroughbred Aviation's brand and high-end clientele for 2 industry conferences, contributing to a 10% increase in calls and sales among those clients.
- Developed Parrish Allen's social media marketing strategy and managed an event featuring established recording artists, helping him gain 2,500 new followers in one month and supporting bookings for a nationwide tour across 14 venues.

Product Strategist | Herbtropia Co. | Michigan / Arizona | September 2023 - Present

- Translated findings from 150+ user and stakeholder interviews into product requirements that addressed barriers to trustworthy wellness discovery and determined the scope of the first release.
- Designed the discovery experience in Figma and practitioner submission workflows within a phased roadmap that prioritized access to wellness offerings before personalized matching.
- Secured \$15,000 in funding to advance Herbtropia's development and refined its practitioner directory model and acquisition strategy to prepare the venture for launch.

Product Development Intern | Ann Arbor Spark | Ann Arbor, MI | May 2024 - August 2024

- Helped identify 70+ prospective clients nationwide for APT Solar Solutions by researching customer needs and assessing their fit with the product's capabilities to inform smart-city expansion recommendations.
- Developed expansion recommendations grounded in market and technical research that accounted for operational constraints and informed leadership's decision to pursue prospective clients identified by the team.

Business Strategy & UX Consultant | HappierMe | Remote | January 2024 - January 2025

- Recruited and trained 15 new ambassadors for a program spanning 10+ schools, creating a repeatable onboarding process that equipped campus representatives to introduce the mental wellness app to students.
- Translated the findings from 5 conducted user interviews and usability tests with first-time users to identify friction in the platform, leading to specific design recommendations such as shorter journaling flows to reduce user effort.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Fourth Soil Farm | E-Commerce & Growth Strategy | January 2024 - May 2024

- Shaped an e-commerce strategy around the distinct purchasing needs of an estimated market of 18,000+ vegetarian/vegan-aligned consumers and 400+ local restaurants.
- Built a 5-year financial model projecting revenue growth from \$15,600 to \$390,000, with restaurants accounting for 60% of projected Year-5 revenue to assess their role in the growth strategy.

IMPROVE | Market Analysis & Strategic Growth Consulting | January 2025 - May 2025

- Developed a growth plan for a leadership-training firm using competitor research and buyer feedback to recommend how it could differentiate its services and attract corporate clients.

SKILLS

Product: Customer discovery, requirements definition, feature prioritization, roadmap planning, market and competitive analysis, go-to-market strategy, stakeholder communication, project coordination, business models, research synthesis

Tools: Excel, Google Sheets, SQL, Python, Figma, Qualtrics, HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Google Apps Script, Google Workspace, AI-assisted workflows